

- abrasive** harsh; wearing away by rubbing
accessible easy to reach or understand
adorn decorate or enhance the appearance
advantageous beneficial or providing a favorable position
affection fondness
affinity a natural liking or kinship
ambiguity uncertainty or doubtfulness
ambiguous unclear or open to multiple interpretations
ambivalent having mixed or conflicting feelings
analogical reasoning by comparison
analogous similar in a way that allows comparison
annotate add explanatory notes to
anomaly something that deviates from norms or expectations
antecedent something that comes before
antithetical directly opposed
appraising assessing the value or significance of something
appropriate fitting for the situation
approximate close but not exact
arcane obscure; known to few
atypical not typical; unusual for its kind
authoritative influential or clearly accurate
blemish a spoiling flaw
burdensome heavy to carry or bear
buttress defend
catastrophic disastrous
chaotic utterly disordered
circumvent get around by cleverness
circumvents gets around by cleverness
cohesion holding together as a whole
committed pledged; devoted
commonplace ordinary; met with everywhere
complementary completing each other; better together
composure calmness under pressure
compound make greater by adding to
concealed hidden
concede admit something is true, often reluctantly
conclude decide after reasoning
conclusions judgments reached by reasoning
conjectures guesses
consensus agreement
constraint repression of one's behavior or actions
contentious causing argument
contrived artificially arranged; forced
corroborate confirm or support with evidence
corroboration evidence to support or prove something
counteract act against so as to cancel
counterfactual contrary to the facts; a what-if
curtailed cut short or reduced
deceptive misleading
decisiveness the ability to decide firmly
deference respectful yielding to another
defied resisted or openly refused
defunct no longer existing or functioning
delegate hand a task to someone else
denigrate speak of as worthless
depleted used up; drained
despise regard with contempt
desultory aimless; jumping about without plan
deviates departs from the usual course
dictate guide or dominate
discern to detect or recognize something, especially something hidden or obscure
discounted downplayed or ignored
discourage make less willing
discretion good judgment about what to say
disengage detach; withdraw from
disingenuously insincerely, while pretending honesty
disorienting causing loss of bearings
disparage belittle

disparate essentially different; not comparable
dispassionately without emotion or bias
dispersed scattered widely
disseminate spread widely
diverge move apart; differ
diverse varied; of many kinds
dogmatic insisting on beliefs without allowing doubt
dominance the state of being more successful than others
dormant inactive for now, but able to revive
dwindling steadily shrinking
earnest serious and sincere
eclipses outshines; blocks from view
elasticity the ability to stretch and return
elusive hard to catch or pin down
empirical based on observation, not theory
endorse openly approve or recommend
engendering producing or causing to exist
entrenching solidifying
epitomize be a perfect example of
epitomizing being a perfect example of
esteem high regard
evasion avoiding by cleverness
exactitude precision
exemplifications illustrations by example
exhaustive thorough; leaving nothing out
expediency what is convenient rather than right
explicable explainable or understandable
exploit make full use of; take unfair advantage of
exploiting making full use of
extol praise highly or glorify
extraneous irrelevant; not belonging
fabricates makes up; invents falsely
facile easy in a shallow way
feasible possible to do or achieve
fecundity fruitfulness; ability to produce much
foretells predicts
foster encourage the growth of

foundational forming the base everything rests on
fruitless producing no result
habitual done regularly, by habit
hampered held back; made harder
haphazard without plan or order
heterogeneity the state of being varied in kind
hibernation a long winter sleep
hinder get in the way of
hoard store up and keep back
homogeneous uniform throughout; all of one kind
hypothesized made a tentative assumption to be evaluated in a study or experiment
illustrated shown by example
immature not fully developed
impartial not favouring either side
impede obstruct; slow down
impending imminent or approaching
impenetrable impossible to get into or understand
implement put into practice
implicit suggested or understood without being directly expressed
impractical not sensible to do in practice
improvise make up on the spot
incongruous out of keeping; not fitting together
inconspicuousness discreetness
indecipherable impossible to read or make sense of
indisputable impossible to question or deny
indistinct uncertain or not clearly recognizable
individualistic acting on one's own lines
inertia the tendency to stay as it is
inexplicable impossible to explain
infallible problematic
innocuous harmless
innovative introducing new methods

insignificance the state of not mattering

insurmountable impossible to overcome or too difficult to solve

intangible unable to be physically handled or touched

integral essential to the whole

interchangeable able to be swapped without difference

interjected cut in with a remark

intersect cross or overlap

intricate finely detailed and complicated

invalidate make void; show to be wrong

inventive good at thinking up new things

involuntarily without meaning to; not by choice

invulnerable impossible to harm

jarring unpleasantly out of place

latent present but not yet showing

localized confined to one place

lucrative producing a lot of money

marginalize treat as unimportant or relatively powerless within a group or society

melodic tuneful; pleasant to hear

mimic copy or imitate closely

misanthropic disliking people in general

misconstrue take the wrong meaning from

misgiving a feeling of doubt

mitigate to make less severe or reduce the negative effects of something

moderation keeping within reasonable limits

modesty not boasting about oneself

monetizing turning into a source of money

multifaceted having many sides or aspects

mystifying puzzling; hard to explain

negating reversing or making invalid

negligible too small to matter

neutrality taking neither side

notional theoretical or only an idea

novel new and unlike what came before

nuanced alert to fine distinctions

nullify cancel out; make of no effect

obscure hard to make out, or little known

obstructed blocked

obviated made unnecessary or redundant

offhand casual; without preparation

opaque difficult to understand or unclear

operative in force; working

optimistic expecting the best

optimize make the most effective possible use of available opportunities

ornamental decorative rather than useful

outmoded no longer in fashion or use

outspoken frank in saying what one thinks

outstrip go faster or further than

perceptible able to be noticed

peripheral at the edge; not central

perpetual never ending

powerful having great force or influence

pragmatic concerned with what works

precariousness instability

predatory preying on others

predetermined settled in advance

prefiguring an early indicator

premeditated planned beforehand

prescribed laid down as a rule

prestige widely recognized standing

presume take for granted

presuppose assume beforehand

pretentious claiming more importance than is due

prevail win out; be widespread

prioritize put first in order of importance

probability likelihood

proclaims announces publicly

proficient skilled

profound deep; far-reaching

protracted drawn out over time or space

prudent careful and sensible

questioned expressed doubt about

realized came to understand; brought about

rebut proves a claim or argument to be false

recalcitrant stubbornly refusing to comply
recants takes back what was said
reciprocate return in kind
reciprocates returns the same in kind
reciprocity an exchange of like for like
recognition being identified or
acknowledged
rectify to correct or remedy something
undesirable
redefined given a new meaning
redundant more than needed; repeating
refute prove wrong
regretted felt sorry about
remember call back to mind
renounce give up formally
replenishes fills up again
replicable able to be reproduced
repudiates rejects firmly; disowns
resigned accepting what cannot be
changed
resilience persistence
restrained held back; controlled
restraint holding back
retaliates strikes back
retrospective looking back on the past
rousing stirring; exciting
routine a regular way of doing things
rudimentary basic; only partly developed
sanguine optimistic
satisfying meeting a need or expectation
scheme a plan, often a crafty one
scholarly showing careful learning
select pick out
shrewd sharp in practical judgment
simulate imitate the workings of
situated located
sophisticated refined; highly developed
spurious false, though appearing genuine
stymie block; frustrate the progress of
substantial considerable in size or
importance
substantiate verify with evidence

substantiating supporting with proof
subtle complex or understated
subversive seeking to undermine
succinctly briefly and clearly
succumb give way; yield
summations summaries
superseded surpassed or exceeded by
something else
supposition an assumption or hypothesis
that is not yet proven
suppress hold down; keep from being
expressed
surmised concluded from slight evidence
surreptitiously secretly, to avoid being
noticed
synopsis a brief outline
tangential only slightly related
tedious tiresomely long or dull
tenuous thin and weak; barely holding
tranquil free from disturbance, or calm
transcending rising above the limits of
turnover the rate at which things are
replaced
ubiquitous found everywhere
ubiquity the state of being everywhere
unassuming modest; not drawing attention
uncontroversial not disputed
undeniable impossible to argue against
underscore emphasize
unimportant carrying no weight
unobtrusive not drawing attention
unoriginal copied; not new
unpretentious not claiming importance;
plain
unworkable not able to be made to work
variable liable to change; not fixed
veritable genuine; truly so called
vigilance watchful attention
vivid sharp and clear to the senses
waive give up a right
yield give way; or produce